SCHOOL OF BUSINESS STUDIES

ACCOUNTANCY — Complete 50-Page Course Module

Beginner → Intermediate

Financial Accounting • Cost Accounting • Management Accounting • Auditing • Taxation • Business Systems

A structured Accountancy course covering accounting principles, double-entry bookkeeping, financial statements, cost accounting, budgeting, taxation, auditing, internal control, computerized accounting, ethics, and practical business accounting.

Course Overview

Purpose: This module provides a foundation in accountancy for learners in the School of Business Studies.

Learning outcomes: Learners should be able to record basic transactions, apply double-entry principles, prepare trial balances and financial statements, analyze costs, prepare budgets, understand auditing and internal controls, and use accounting information for business decisions.

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Lesson 1: Introduction to Accountancy

Lesson Content

Accountancy is the systematic process of identifying, recording, classifying, summarizing, analyzing, and communicating financial information. It supports decision-making by owners, managers, investors, lenders, government, and other stakeholders.

Exercise

Define accountancy and state five users of accounting information.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 2: Nature and Objectives of Accounting

Lesson Content

Accounting provides reliable information about financial position, performance, cash flows, and changes in equity. Its objectives include record keeping, stewardship, planning, control, and decision support.

Exercise

List six objectives of accounting.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 3: Accounting Concepts and Principles

Lesson Content

Fundamental concepts include business entity, going concern, consistency, accrual, prudence, materiality, and historical or appropriate measurement concepts. Specific reporting frameworks determine applicable requirements.

Exercise

Explain the business entity and going-concern concepts.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 4: The Accounting Equation

Lesson Content

The fundamental relationship is Assets = Capital/Equity + Liabilities. Transactions change at least two elements while maintaining the equation.

Exercise

Use the accounting equation to determine an unknown amount.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 5: Assets, Liabilities and Equity

Lesson Content

Assets are resources controlled by an entity, liabilities are present obligations, and equity represents the residual interest after liabilities are deducted from assets.

Exercise

Give five examples each of assets and liabilities.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 6: Revenue, Expenses and Profit

Lesson Content

Revenue represents income from ordinary activities or other recognized sources, while expenses are costs incurred in generating income. Profit or loss reflects the difference between relevant income and expenses.

Exercise

Differentiate revenue, expense, profit, and loss.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 7: Double-Entry Bookkeeping

Lesson Content

Every transaction is recorded using at least two entries so that debits and credits maintain accounting equality. The system supports completeness and systematic classification.

Exercise

Explain the principle of double-entry bookkeeping.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 8: Debits and Credits

Lesson Content

Debit and credit are sides of an account, not simply synonyms for increase and decrease. Their effect depends on the account type and the accounting framework.

Exercise

State the normal debit or credit balance for major account classes.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 9: Source Documents

Lesson Content

Invoices, receipts, payment vouchers, credit notes, debit notes, bank documents, payroll records, and purchase orders provide evidence for accounting entries.

Exercise

List eight common accounting source documents.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 10: Books of Original Entry

Lesson Content

Transactions are initially recorded in appropriate books such as sales journals, purchases journals, cash books, and general journals before posting to ledger accounts.

Exercise

What is the purpose of a book of original entry?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 11: The Ledger

Lesson Content

A ledger contains individual accounts where transactions are classified and accumulated. Balancing accounts supports preparation of trial balances and financial statements.

Exercise

Explain the difference between a journal and a ledger.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 12: Trial Balance

Lesson Content

A trial balance lists ledger balances to test the arithmetic equality of debits and credits. Agreement does not prove that every accounting error has been eliminated.

Exercise

State two purposes and two limitations of a trial balance.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 13: Cash Book

Lesson Content

The cash book records cash and bank transactions and may include columns for discounts. It can function as both a book of original entry and a ledger account.

Exercise

Name three types of cash book.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 14: Petty Cash

Lesson Content

Petty cash is used for small routine payments. An imprest system establishes a fixed float that is replenished based on documented expenditure.

Exercise

Explain the imprest petty-cash system.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 15: Bank Reconciliation

Lesson Content

A bank reconciliation compares the cash book bank balance with the bank statement and explains timing differences, errors, and unrecorded items.

Exercise

List five causes of differences between cash book and bank statement balances.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 16: Accounting Errors

Lesson Content

Errors can arise from omission, commission, principle, original entry, reversal, duplication, or compensating mistakes. Detection and correction require systematic review.

Exercise

Explain the difference between an error of principle and an error of omission.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 17: Suspense Account

Lesson Content

A suspense account may temporarily hold an unexplained difference when trial-balance totals do not agree. It should be cleared after errors are identified and corrected.

Exercise

Why should a suspense account not remain unexplained?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 18: Capital and Revenue Expenditure

Lesson Content

Capital expenditure generally creates or improves long-term assets or benefits, while revenue expenditure relates to ordinary operating costs. Classification affects financial statements.

Exercise

Differentiate capital expenditure and revenue expenditure.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 19: Inventory Accounting

Lesson Content

Inventory includes goods held for sale or production. Accounting requires appropriate measurement and recognition of cost and, where applicable, write-downs to recoverable or realizable amounts.

Exercise

Explain why inventory valuation affects profit.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 20: Depreciation

Lesson Content

Depreciation allocates the depreciable amount of a long-term tangible asset over its useful life. Common methods include straight-line and reducing-balance methods.

Exercise

Why is depreciation charged?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 21: Bad Debts and Allowances

Lesson Content

Credit sales can result in amounts that are not collected. Accounting may recognize bad debts and appropriate allowances or expected-credit-loss concepts under applicable standards.

Exercise

Explain why businesses recognize credit losses.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 22: Control Accounts

Lesson Content

Control accounts summarize groups of subsidiary ledger balances, such as receivables or payables, and provide an independent check against detailed records.

Exercise

What is the purpose of a receivables control account?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 23: Receivables and Payables

Lesson Content

Receivables are amounts owed to the business, while payables are amounts owed by the business. Effective credit control supports liquidity and reduces collection risk.

Exercise

Differentiate trade receivables and trade payables.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 24: Manufacturing Accounts

Lesson Content

Manufacturing accounts summarize production costs such as direct materials, direct labor, and production overheads to determine cost of production.

Exercise

Name three major components of manufacturing cost.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 25: Cost Accounting Fundamentals

Lesson Content

Cost accounting identifies, measures, analyzes, and controls costs. It supports pricing, budgeting, efficiency analysis, and management decisions.

Exercise

Differentiate direct and indirect costs.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 26: Fixed, Variable and Semi-Variable Costs

Lesson Content

Fixed costs remain broadly constant within a relevant activity range, variable costs change with activity, and semi-variable costs contain both components.

Exercise

Give three examples of fixed and variable costs.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 27: Marginal Costing

Lesson Content

Marginal costing focuses on variable cost and contribution. Contribution equals sales less variable cost and can support short-term decisions.

Exercise

What is contribution?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 28: Break-Even Analysis

Lesson Content

Break-even analysis identifies the activity or sales level where total revenue equals total relevant cost. It supports planning and risk analysis.

Exercise

State the break-even point formula in units.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 29: Budgeting

Lesson Content

Budgets translate plans into quantified targets for revenue, expenditure, production, cash, and other activities. They support planning and control.

Exercise

List five types of budgets.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 30: Cash Budget

Lesson Content

A cash budget forecasts cash receipts, payments, and expected cash balances. It helps identify financing needs and potential surpluses.

Exercise

Why is a cash budget important?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 31: Standard Costing and Variance Analysis

Lesson Content

Standard costing compares expected costs with actual results. Variances are analyzed to identify causes and support corrective action.

Exercise

What is a variance?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 32: Financial Statements

Lesson Content

Core financial statements commonly include a statement of financial position, statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income, statement of cash flows, and changes in equity, subject to applicable reporting requirements.

Exercise

Name four major financial statements.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 33: Statement of Financial Position

Lesson Content

This statement presents assets, liabilities, and equity at a particular date. It helps users assess financial position, liquidity structure, and capital employed.

Exercise

What does the statement of financial position show?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 34: Statement of Profit or Loss

Lesson Content

The statement of profit or loss reports income and expenses for a period and determines profit or loss according to applicable accounting requirements.

Exercise

What is the purpose of the statement of profit or loss?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 35: Cash Flow Statement

Lesson Content

Cash flow reporting explains movements in cash and cash equivalents, commonly classified into operating, investing, and financing activities.

Exercise

Name the three broad categories of cash flows.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 36: Ratio Analysis

Lesson Content

Ratios help analyze profitability, liquidity, efficiency, and financial structure. Ratios are most useful when compared with prior periods, budgets, or appropriate benchmarks.

Exercise

Name five accounting ratios.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 37: Partnership Accounts

Lesson Content

A partnership is a business operated by two or more persons under agreed terms. Accounting may address capital accounts, current accounts, profit sharing, admission, retirement, and dissolution.

Exercise

What is a partnership agreement?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 38: Company Accounts

Lesson Content

Company accounting covers share capital, reserves, retained earnings, dividends, financial reporting, and other matters relevant to corporate entities under applicable law and standards.

Exercise

Differentiate ordinary shares and preference shares.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 39: Public Sector Accounting

Lesson Content

Public-sector accounting supports accountability for public resources, budgeting, reporting, control, and compliance with applicable government financial frameworks.

Exercise

Why is accountability important in public-sector accounting?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 40: Taxation Basics

Lesson Content

Tax accounting considers applicable taxes on income, transactions, payroll, consumption, and other activities. Requirements depend on jurisdiction and current law.

Exercise

Why should accountants verify current tax rules before applying them?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 41: Payroll Accounting

Lesson Content

Payroll accounting records wages, salaries, deductions, employer obligations, and net pay. Accurate payroll requires reliable employee and attendance records.

Exercise

List six items commonly considered in payroll accounting.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 42: Accounting Information Systems

Lesson Content

Accounting information systems collect, process, store, and report financial data. Controls help protect data integrity, authorization, confidentiality, and availability.

Exercise

What is an accounting information system?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 43: Computerized Accounting

Lesson Content

Accounting software automates transaction entry, ledgers, invoicing, reporting, reconciliation, and other processes. Automation improves speed but does not eliminate the need for controls and review.

Exercise

Give five benefits of computerized accounting.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 44: Internal Control

Lesson Content

Internal controls are policies and procedures designed to safeguard assets, ensure reliable records, promote operational effectiveness, and support compliance.

Exercise

List eight examples of internal controls.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 45: Auditing Fundamentals

Lesson Content

Auditing involves systematic examination and evaluation of information or records against suitable criteria. Independent assurance can increase users' confidence in financial information.

Exercise

Differentiate accounting from auditing.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 46: Ethics and Professional Conduct

Lesson Content

Accountants are expected to demonstrate integrity, objectivity, professional competence and due care, confidentiality, and professional behavior under applicable ethical requirements.

Exercise

Why is professional ethics important in accountancy?

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 47: Accounting for Small Businesses

Lesson Content

Small businesses need organized source documents, cash control, inventory records, receivable and payable tracking, budgeting, tax records, and periodic financial statements.

Exercise

Create a basic accounting system for a small business.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Lesson 48: Final Revision and Professional Practice

Lesson Content

Accountancy combines recording, reporting, analysis, planning, control, ethics, technology, and professional judgment. Good accounting depends on accurate evidence, appropriate standards, strong controls, and clear documentation.

Exercise

Summarize the accounting cycle from transaction to financial reporting.

Lesson checkpoint: Write three key ideas, one question, and one practical example from this lesson.

Final Assessment: 60 Questions and Answers

Attempt each question before reading the answer.

1. What is accountancy?

Answer: The systematic identification, recording, classification, summarization, analysis, and communication of financial information.

2. Name five users of accounting information.

Answer: Owners, managers, investors, lenders, government agencies, employees, and other stakeholders.

3. What is the business entity concept?

Answer: It treats the business as an accounting unit separate from its owners.

4. What is going concern?

Answer: The assumption that an entity will continue operating for the foreseeable future unless evidence indicates otherwise.

5. State the accounting equation.

Answer: Assets = Equity + Liabilities.

6. What is an asset?

Answer: A resource controlled by an entity as a result of past events from which future economic benefits are expected.

7. What is a liability?

Answer: A present obligation arising from past events that is expected to result in an outflow of resources.

8. What is equity?

Answer: The residual interest in assets after deducting liabilities.

9. What is revenue?

Answer: Income arising from an entity's ordinary activities and other recognized sources according to applicable standards.

10. What is an expense?

Answer: A decrease in economic benefits or an increase in obligations that reduces equity, excluding distributions to owners.

11. What is profit?

Answer: The excess of recognized income over expenses for a period.

12. What is double-entry bookkeeping?

Answer: A system in which transactions are recorded with corresponding debit and credit entries.

13. What is a debit?

Answer: The left side of an account used according to the account's classification and accounting rules.

14. What is a credit?

Answer: The right side of an account used according to the account's classification and accounting rules.

15. Name five source documents.

Answer: Invoices, receipts, credit notes, debit notes, payment vouchers, and bank documents.

16. What is a journal?

Answer: A book or record used to initially record transactions before or as they are posted to ledger accounts.

17. What is a ledger?

Answer: A collection of classified accounts containing transaction records and balances.

18. What is a trial balance?

Answer: A list of ledger balances used mainly to test the arithmetic equality of debit and credit totals.

19. Does a balanced trial balance prove there are no errors?

Answer: No. Some errors do not affect the equality of trial-balance totals.

20. What is a cash book?

Answer: A record of cash and bank transactions, often including related discount information.

21. What is petty cash?

Answer: A small cash fund used for minor routine payments.

22. What is an imprest system?

Answer: A petty-cash system in which a fixed float is restored periodically by the amount spent.

23. What is bank reconciliation?

Answer: A process of comparing the cash book bank record with the bank statement and explaining differences.

24. What is an accounting error?

Answer: A mistake or omission in recording, classification, measurement, or processing of accounting information.

25. What is a suspense account?

Answer: A temporary account used to hold an unexplained difference until the underlying error is identified.

26. What is capital expenditure?

Answer: Expenditure that generally creates or improves a long-term asset or provides benefits beyond the current period.

27. What is revenue expenditure?

Answer: Expenditure related mainly to ordinary operating activities and current-period benefits.

28. What is inventory?

Answer: Goods or materials held for sale, production, or consumption in the production process, as applicable.

29. Why is inventory valuation important?

Answer: It affects reported assets, cost of sales, and profit.

30. What is depreciation?

Answer: Systematic allocation of a depreciable asset's amount over its useful life.

31. Name two depreciation methods.

Answer: Straight-line and reducing-balance methods.

32. What is a bad debt?

Answer: A receivable amount that is determined to be uncollectible.

33. What is a receivable?

Answer: An amount owed to the business, usually by a customer.

34. What is a payable?

Answer: An amount the business owes to another party.

35. What is a control account?

Answer: A summary ledger account that provides an independent check on detailed subsidiary records.

36. What is direct cost?

Answer: A cost that can be conveniently traced to a specific cost object.

37. What is indirect cost?

Answer: A cost that cannot be conveniently traced to a specific cost object and is allocated or apportioned.

38. What is a fixed cost?

Answer: A cost that remains broadly constant within a relevant activity range.

39. What is a variable cost?

Answer: A cost that changes with the level of activity.

40. What is contribution?

Answer: Sales revenue less variable costs.

41. What is break-even point?

Answer: The level of activity at which total revenue equals total relevant cost.

42. Give the break-even formula in units.

Answer: Fixed costs divided by contribution per unit.

43. What is a budget?

Answer: A quantified plan for a future period.

44. What is a cash budget?

Answer: A forecast of expected cash receipts, payments, and balances.

45. What is a variance?

Answer: The difference between a planned or standard amount and an actual result.

46. Name four financial statements.

Answer: Statement of financial position, statement of profit or loss, statement of cash flows, and statement of changes in equity.

47. What does the statement of financial position show?

Answer: Assets, liabilities, and equity at a particular reporting date.

48. What does the statement of profit or loss show?

Answer: Income and expenses for a period and the resulting profit or loss.

49. What are the three cash-flow categories?

Answer: Operating, investing, and financing activities.

50. What is ratio analysis?

Answer: Use of financial ratios to evaluate aspects of financial performance and position.

51. Name four types of ratios.

Answer: Profitability, liquidity, efficiency/activity, and financial structure/gearing ratios.

52. What is a partnership?

Answer: A business relationship in which two or more persons operate a business under agreed terms.

53. What is share capital?

Answer: Capital raised by a company through issuing shares.

54. What is public-sector accounting?

Answer: Accounting for public resources, transactions, budgets, reporting, and accountability.

55. What is payroll accounting?

Answer: Recording and processing employee compensation, deductions, employer obligations, and net pay.

56. What is an accounting information system?

Answer: A system that collects, processes, stores, and reports accounting information.

57. What is internal control?

Answer: Policies and procedures designed to safeguard assets, support reliable information, improve operations, and promote compliance.

58. What is auditing?

Answer: Systematic examination and evaluation of information or records against suitable criteria.

59. Why is ethics important in accountancy?

Answer: It supports integrity, objectivity, confidentiality, competence, public trust, and professional behavior.

Practical Exercises

Exercise 1 — Accounting Equation

Create ten simple business transactions and show how each affects assets, liabilities, and equity while maintaining the accounting equation.

Exercise 2 — Double Entry

Record a set of cash purchases, credit sales, expenses, receipts, and payments using debit and credit entries. Post them to ledger accounts.

Exercise 3 — Bank Reconciliation

Prepare a bank reconciliation using a cash-book balance, bank-statement balance, outstanding cheques, deposits in transit, bank charges, and other appropriate reconciling items.

Exercise 4 — Budgeting

Prepare a one-month cash budget for a small business using expected sales receipts, purchases, wages, rent, utilities, and other expenses.

Exercise 5 — Financial Analysis

Using a simple set of financial statements, calculate selected profitability, liquidity, efficiency, and financial-structure ratios and interpret the results.

Accountancy Glossary

Accountancy: Systematic recording, classification, reporting, analysis, and communication of financial information.

Asset: Controlled resource expected to provide economic benefits.

Liability: Present obligation expected to result in an outflow of resources.

Equity: Residual interest after liabilities are deducted from assets.

Revenue: Recognized income from ordinary and other relevant activities.

Expense: Recognized cost or decrease in economic benefits.

Profit: Excess of recognized income over expenses.

Debit: Left side of an account.

Credit: Right side of an account.

Journal: Record used for initial transaction entry.

Ledger: Collection of classified accounts.

Trial balance: List of ledger balances used to test debit-credit equality.

Cash book: Record of cash and bank transactions.

Petty cash: Small fund for minor payments.

Bank reconciliation: Comparison and explanation of cash-book and bank-statement differences.

Depreciation: Systematic allocation of a depreciable asset's amount over its useful life.

Inventory: Goods or materials held for sale or production.

Receivable: Amount owed to a business.

Payable: Amount owed by a business.

Budget: Quantified plan for a future period.

Variance: Difference between planned/standard and actual results.

Contribution: Sales less variable costs.

Break-even: Activity level where total revenue equals total relevant cost.

Audit: Systematic examination and evaluation against suitable criteria.

Internal control: Procedures designed to safeguard assets and improve reliability and compliance.

Accounting information system: System that processes and reports accounting data.

End of School of Business Studies — Accountancy

Accountancy combines accurate record keeping, financial reporting, analysis, planning, control, technology, ethics, and professional judgment. Always apply the accounting standards and legal requirements relevant to the jurisdiction and reporting context.